

HKUST MSc Program in Artificial Intelligence

ARIN 6900 Capstone Project Guidelines

I. Course Description

AIRN 6900 is a required 6-credit course in the MSc in Artificial Intelligence program, and lasts for 2 semesters (normally Spring and Summer for full-time students, Fall and Spring for part-time students). It is a capstone project that integrates what you have learned in the program under the supervision of an academic supervisor and an industry partner. This project course will provide you with an opportunity to apply AI technologies learned to solve problems encountered in real-world applications. The objective is to allow you to be better prepared for AI jobs in various sectors. You are expected to complete most core courses before starting the project to ensure you are well prepared for this final stage of the program.

II. Registration Procedure

1. Identify a supervisor and project title

Go through the list of supervisors and project titles available on the [MSc Project Enrollment Request System](#) to identify a potential supervisor and project title. Each supervisor may supervise up to **ten** students at a time. Each project also has a fixed quota for the number of participants, and once the quota is full, the project will not be available in the online project enrollment request system.

2. Prepare a proposal

Prepare a one-page proposal for the project for consideration by the supervisor and Program Director. The proposal should cover but not limited to the following:

- a) The title and brief description of the project,
- b) Methodology, and
- c) Project planning.

3. Complete the request for approval online

Complete the request for approval and upload the project proposal via the [MSc Project Enrollment Request System](#) **at least 5 working days prior to the add/drop deadline.**

Please read *Procedure for Online Application of MSc Independent Project (Procedure for OAPS)* on Canvas for details.

4. Submit a request for “Instructor’s Consent”

Upon approval from the MSc Project Enrollment Request System, submit a request for “Instructor’s Consent” via [Class Enrollment Request](#) on Student Intranet.

5. Enroll in the course

When the request “Instructor’s Consent” is approved, you will receive an email notification. As the last step, click on “Enroll” in the email to register for the course.

You should complete ALL the above five steps to complete course registration by the end of the add/drop period.

III. Timeline and Assessment (2025/26, Full-Time)

Students who start ARIN 6900 in Spring 2026 should

- 1) Submit the following documents to the project supervisor(s), AND
- 2) Upload a copy to Canvas ARIN 6900 course page by the stipulated deadlines for review:

Due Date	Assessment Tasks	Assessment Weightings (%)
February 9, 2026	Project proposal (see 2.2 for details)	20
May 29, 2026	Interim report* , including achievement with evidence, deliverables update (if any), and minutes of at least 2 meetings with project supervisors.	40
July 31, 2026	Final report* . It should describe the work carried out in the project and include, but not be limited to, introduction, design, implementation, testing, evaluation, discussion, conclusions, and minutes of at least 4 meetings with project supervisors.	40

**You are expected to spend a minimum of 12 hours per week working on the project and meet with supervisors at least 2 times each semester.*

IV. References

- Minh Trinh, “The AI Project Handbook: How to Manage a Successful Artificial Intelligence Project”, Rodeo Press, 2021.
- Irene Bratsis, “The AI Product Manager’s Handbook: Develop a Product That Takes Advantage of Machine Learning to Solve AI Problems”, Packt Publishing, 2023.

(Last updated on January 19, 2026)

Appendix A

Sample Minutes

Minutes of the 1st Project Meeting

Date Wednesday, February 20, 2026

Time 10:00 am

Place Room 1234

Present Andrew Ng
Prof Michael Jordan

Apology None

Note-taker Andrew Ng

1. Approval of minutes

This was the first group meeting, so there were no minutes to approve.

2. Discussion items

Things to do

3. Meeting adjournment and next meeting

The meeting adjourned at 10:45 AM. The next meeting will be held in April.